

Prep Hours

Manually add prep hours to substrates in estimates with automatic cost calculation based on your internal hourly rate.

Prep hours in PaintScout must be added manually to each substrate. The system multiplies your prep hours by your internal hourly rate to calculate the prep cost, which is then added to the surface total alongside painting time and materials.

How do you add prep hours to an estimate?

1. Select the substrate to which you want to assign prep hours.
2. Enter the number of prep hours in the designated box. Keep in mind that the hourly rate will be applied to determine the cost. For instance, if you allocate 2 hours of prep for a substrate, it will be **2 hrs x \$65 hourly = \$130.00** in total for prep.

Edit Surface
CHANGE SELECTION

INTERNAL LABEL			CLIENT LABEL	
8 ft Walls			Walls	
LENGTH (FT)	WIDTH (FT)	HEIGHT (FT)	SWITCH TO SQFT ↗	
10	10	11		
RATE (SQFT/HR)	COATS	PREP (HR)	PAINTING (HR)	
100	2	2	4.5	
CALCULATED PRICE (\$)			☒ Show Formula	
422.50				

$$\left(\left(\underset{\text{ROOM (sqft)}}{440} \div \underset{\text{RATE (sqft/hr)}}{100} = \underset{\text{LABOR (hr)}}{4.5} \right) + \underset{\text{PREP (hr)}}{2} \right) \times \underset{\text{HOURLY (\$/hr)}}{65.00} = \underset{\text{TOTAL}}{422.50}$$

3. Click **Confirm**, and you'll see the prep hours incorporated into your area.

Estimate

Description	Qty	Prep (hr)	Painting (hr)	Total (hr)	Materials (\$)	Labor (\$)	Total (\$)
Walls 8 ft Walls - 432sqft		1	3	4	118.80	260.00	378.80 ...

Calculate your all-in hourly rate for painting estimates by combining labor wages, materials, overhead costs, and profit margin with step-by-step examples.